

MGT 429 – Topics in Corporate Governance – Leadership in a Crisis

STUDENT CLASS (FT)

TERM (SU 2025)

PROFESSOR: Blair L. Sadler, JD

EMAIL: Bsadler@ucsd.edu

PHONE: 858-336-0587

OFFICE HOURS: By Appointment

FACULTY ASSISTANT: Emma Gu

FA EMAIL: yug059@ucsd.edu

DESCRIPTION

Class Size limited to 35.

A defining moment in the history of an organization is how it responds to a highly visible crisis that causes real harm to individuals or communities. In today's environment of 24/7 communication and global transparency, the need to be prepared and to act quickly and effectively is essential. Organizations must balance their own interests with the public interest. Crises involving Toyota, General Motors, United Airlines, Wells Fargo, the Catholic Church, Michigan State University, and the Boy Scouts of America provide vivid examples of the damage caused by the lack of effective leadership during a crisis. The Covid-19 crisis provides a clear and compelling picture of the damage caused by the lack of transparent leadership and the positive benefits of being honest and open.

This course will provide you with the opportunity to develop your own crisis management plan as part of a team, to define leadership roles, and to make two videotaped presentations that will be evaluated by your colleagues and me. This course will provide a vibrant, highly interactive learning environment designed to help you experience what it's like to successfully navigate through a complex and challenging simulated crisis which has the potential to cause considerable loss of public image and trust. Ernest Rady will be a visiting speaker during the third class.

A collateral benefit will be to identify your most effective communication styles. Students will expand their existing repertoire of communications skills by watching peers demonstrate alternative styles. Student teams will make brief presentations in class in a simulated press conference, assuring that they will receive helpful feedback from classmates and from me on how to improve their content, style, and credibility during a crisis presentation. By the conclusion of this course, you should have a clear idea of your personal strengths and weaknesses and be able to build on your strengths. Students will also see the value of working with a communications coach and in preparing far in advance. This class will provide a safe environment for students who are seeking to improve their public speaking skills in stressful situations, and deepen your confidence to assume leadership roles going forward.

OBJECTIVES

In this course, you will:

Learn how to identify the stakeholders involved in a crisis

Learn how to balance an organization's interest with the public interest

Learn how to provide effective leadership and understand leadership roles in a crisis

Learn how to develop your own crisis management plan as part of a team

Learn how to communicate effectively in a simulated press conference

Learn how to help your organization be better prepared to handle a future crisis

Develop enhanced confidence to assume leadership roles and seek leadership opportunities.

MATERIALS

Required: Sadler B. and Stewart K. Leading in a Crisis: the Power of Transparency

<http://www.health.org.uk/publication/leading-crisis-power-transparency>

Conway J, Federico F, Stewart K, Cambell M. Respectful Management of Serious Clinical Adverse Events. 2nd Ed. IHI Innovation Series White Paper, Cambridge, Mass: Institute for Healthcare Improvement, (2011).

<http://www.ihl.org/knowledge/Pages/IHIWhitePapers/RespectfulManagementSeriousClinicalAEsWhitePaper.aspx>

Sadler B. The Ethical Imperative: More Important than Ever, Rady Business Journal, Volume 6, Issue 1, (Winter 2013), p.3.

Sadler B, How a Children's Hospital Discovered Child Pornographers in its Midst, Narrative Matters, Health Affairs, (September 2011), vol.30, no.9, 1795-1798.

Jenny C, Preventing the Exploitation and Abuse of Children, Letter, Health Affairs (April 2012), vol.31, no 9, 883, Sadler B, Preventing Child Abuse, the Author Replies, Health Affairs (April 2012), vol.31, no.9, 883.

Heineman, Jr. B. The Crisis Management from Toyota and GM: "It's Our Problem the Moment We Hear About It" Harvard Business Review, (March 20, 2014).

[The Crisis Management Lesson from Toyota and GM: "It's Our Problem the Moment We Hear About It" - Harvard Business Review](#)

Recommended

- Patterson K, Grenny J, McMillan R, Switzler A. Crucial Conversations: Tools for Talking When Stakes Are High. NY: McGraw-Hill, 2002.
- Zander RS and Zander B. The Art of Possibility. Boston, Massachusetts, Harvard Business School Press, 2000.

SCHEDULE

[Include dates for exams, quizzes, due dates for major assignments, and any *required* special events. You can add a detailed schedule with links to PowerPoint slides, readings, and other materials to the "Lessons" tab in Radar.] Course Title: MGT 219: Crisis Management

Class Date	Due by Class Date & the End of Class	Class Topic & Activities	Assignments
Week 1(7/2)	Prior to the class, become familiar with the contents of IHI's White Paper: <i>Respectful Management of Serious Clinical Adverse Events</i>. Read the Sadler & Stewart article and be familiar with the Three Victims in a Crisis. A copy of each group's completed "<i>Fictional Crisis Scenario and Team Members</i>" (developed during class) will be turned in prior to the next class.	Overview, and Creation of Teams 6:30 to 6:45 Mr. Sadler will review the goals and objectives of the course. 6:45 -7:45 Mr. Sadler will review his own experience as a health care leader and Rady Children's CEO 7:45 to 8:00 break 8:00 to 9:00 Form teams of five, define the crisis to be managed, and identify roles. Each team develops outlines of their crisis management plans and their key messages for the first 48 hours following discovery of the crisis. 9:00 to 9:20 Mr. Sadler will demonstrate how to mock up a script for live presentation and use in the next class. Review next class objectives.	During the class, students will break into teams of five, define the crisis they propose to manage, assign each member a role within the organization, and assign tasks to be undertaken during the coming week. A copy describing the crisis and the role of each person will be turned in to Mr. Sadler before the next class. During the next week, students will prepare to present their team's crisis management plan <i>for the first 48 hours after the crisis is discovered</i>. Each member of the team will prepare their own script, plus collaborate on their group's overall presentation for the next week.
Week 2(7/9)	In preparing for this class, each team will have developed their crisis management plans for the first 48 hours following discovery of the crisis. During class, three of the seven groups will have 15 minutes to present followed by audience discussion (who will act as the press.) These presentations will be video- taped for review by each student.	Ernest Rady visit confirmed and Presentations by 3 Teams to the class (the "press") 6:30 to 7:30 Conversation with Ernest Rady. 7:30 to 9:15 (including break) Three teams present their crisis communication management plans <i>for the 48 hour window following the discovery of the crisis</i>. Individual team presentations and feedback from the class and Mr. Sadler 9:15 to 9:20 Summary discussion and review of next class objectives.	For this class, each of three teams will have developed their overall communication plan outline for internal and external audiences, including the media. Each group will develop scripts to be used as the basis for individual 3 minute presentations by each team member at a press conference – <i>assuming that it is 48 hours after the crisis was discovered</i>. Due to increased class size, 3 teams will make their presentations. Four will be deferred for Week 3.
Week 3(7/16)	In preparation for class, each presenter in the first 3 groups will submit in writing to Mr. Sadler specific improvements to their crisis plan presented in Class #2. Each person will identify three specific	Lessons Learned: Four Teams make Presentations to the class (the "press") 6:30 to 6:45 Review agenda. 6:45 to 9:00 (including break) Four working groups present their crisis communication plans	Working groups 4,5,6 & 7 will make their simulated press briefings to the class, 3 minutes per person. They will be videotaped Each of the first 3 groups will be prepared to discuss their reflections on the comments received by classmates, Mr. Sadler, and their own observations from class #2. Each work

	improvements they will make in their individual presentation. Teams #4,5,6,7 will give their 15 minute presentations followed by audience discussion (acting as the press)	receiving feedback from the class and Mr. Sadler.	group will develop specific improvements to be made to their plan. Each person will also identify specific improvements in his or her individual presentation.
Week 4(7/23)	In preparation for this class, each team will have prepared a crisis communication plan, <i>assuming two weeks after the crisis</i>. Each individual will have prepared a scripted presentation describing their roles and responsibilities as part of the team.	Five Team Presentations – Two Weeks after Crisis Formal presentation of five teams' agreed upon crisis communication plan at a press conference <i>assuming two weeks after the crisis</i>. Each team member must participate in the presentation. These presentations will be video- taped, to maximize the learning. Response to critiques by each group 6:30 to 6:45 Overview 6::45 to 9:15 (including break) Five teams will present their two week crisis management plan and receive comments from the class, acting as the press. Each person will make a three minute presentation using a detailed script, describing their role and responsibilities going forward. 9:15 to 9:30 Review of final plans and script assignments.	In preparation for this class, teams will be asked to review their crisis management plan compared to the IHI White Paper check list and determine if any important points are missing or changes should be made. Each student will prepare a script to present as part of their team at a simulated press conference, assuming two weeks after the crisis.
Week 5(7/30)	In preparation for this class, students will refine their plans in light of what they learned and identify any questions they wish to discuss. Two teams(#6&#7) will present their two week crisis management plans.	Two Team Presentations and Develop Organizational Crisis Management Plans 6:30 to 7:30 Two teams present their two week crisis management plan. Summary of Best Practices, with examples from each plan and individual lessons learned. 7:30 to 8:00 Review lessons learned from previous classes. 8:00 to 9:20 Each work group develops their organization's crisis management plan, interacting with Mr. Sadler.	As the final product, each team will submit their organization's crisis management plan and individual scripts by the last day of the final exam week. This plan and these scripts will incorporate the suggestions made from previous classes and from discussions in this final class.

		CELEBRATE THAT YOU ARE NOW A FUTURE LEADER OF MANAGING IN A CRISIS!	
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ASSIGNMENTS all assignments are group

Reading Assignments see above and schedule

Team Projects Students will work in groups and develop crisis management plans

Quizzes none

Exams none

Class Participation significant

GRADING

Assignments	Points [or percentage]
Individual 48 hour crisis mgt scripts including post presenting revisions	15
Individual 2 week scripts including post presentation revisions	15
Overall future crisis mgt. plan for your organization	15
Individual oral presentations (15x2)	30
Class participation	25
Total	100

COURSE POLICIES

[Include whatever course policies haven't been covered in the rest of the syllabus; these might include information about attendance, class participation, and making up work.]

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind.

The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at: <http://www-senate.ucsd.edu/manual/appendices/app2.htm#AP14>

How the Honor Code applies to this course:

Students will conduct themselves consistent with the Honor Code

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or fosorio@ucsd.edu.